

Keyworking Session Log

HIQA STANDARDS 1, 2 & 3 · UNCRC ARTICLES 12 & 13 · S.I. 259/1995

Keyworking is central to the child's experience in residential care. HIQA inspectors review keyworker records for **regularity** (minimum fortnightly), **quality of engagement**, **evidence of goal-setting**, and **proof that the child's voice is captured in their own words**. Sessions should be recorded promptly and filed in the child's individual care file.

 **Child Voice Principle (HIQA Standard 1):** The child's views must be recorded in their own language. Inspectors will look for direct quotes, not staff interpretations. Where a child cannot or chooses not to participate, this must be documented with the reason and an alternative offered.

Child's Name / Ref	Keyworker
Session Date	Session No.
Duration	Location
Child willing to participate?	☐ Yes ☐ No — reason: _____ (offer alternative and record)

1 EMOTIONAL WELLBEING CHECK-IN

Use age-appropriate tools (emoji scale, feelings wheel, or open conversation). Record the child's own words.

Area	Child's Own Words / Observations
How are you feeling today? (1-10 or emoji)	
How has your mood been this week?	
Sleep — are you sleeping OK?	
Appetite — are you eating alright?	
Relationships — getting on with peers / staff?	
Family — how are things with your family?	
Anything worrying you or making you anxious?	

2 CARE PLAN GOALS — PROGRESS REVIEW

Goal (from placement / care plan)	What we've been working on	Progress	Child's view
		☐ Good ☐ Some ☐ Stuck	
		☐ Good ☐ Some ☐ Stuck	
		☐ Good ☐ Some ☐ Stuck	

New goals agreed this session:

3 TOPICS DISCUSSED

Topic	Discussed?	Notes / Child's View
Education / school	☐ Y ☐ N	
Health / wellbeing	☐ Y ☐ N	
Family contact / access	☐ Y ☐ N	
Social worker / care plan review	☐ Y ☐ N	
Activities / hobbies / interests	☐ Y ☐ N	
Rights / complaints / advocacy	☐ Y ☐ N	
Transition / leaving care / future	☐ Y ☐ N	
Life skills / independence	☐ Y ☐ N	
Cultural / identity / religion	☐ Y ☐ N	
Peer relationships / social skills	☐ Y ☐ N	

4 SAFEGUARDING & SAFETY CHECK

Does the child feel safe in the centre?	☐ Yes ☐ No — escalated to PIC (detail below)
Any disclosures or concerns raised?	☐ No ☐ Yes — recorded separately & DLP notified
Any signs of self-harm or distress?	☐ No ☐ Yes — risk assessment reviewed
Any bullying concerns (victim or perpetrator)?	☐ No ☐ Yes — detail:
Any online safety / social media concerns?	☐ No ☐ Yes — detail:
Advocacy discussed / EPIC info offered?	☐ Yes ☐ Previously offered
Does the child know how to make a complaint?	☐ Yes ☐ Explained this session

If safeguarding concern identified — detail:

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SECTION 2 — ACTIONS, CHILD VOICE SUMMARY & SESSION INDEX

5 CHILD'S VOICE — DIRECT QUOTES

 Record significant statements from the child in their own words. This is critical inspection evidence. Inspectors will ask: "Can you show me where the child's voice is captured?"

Topic / Context	Child's Exact Words
	"
	"
	"
	"

6 ACTIONS ARISING FROM THIS SESSION

Action	Owner	By When	Completed?
			☐
			☐
			☐
			☐

7 KEYWORKER REFLECTIVE NOTES

Keyworker's professional observations — engagement level, body language, areas of concern, things that went well.

8 SESSION OUTCOME SUMMARY

Overall engagement level	☐ Fully engaged ☐ Partially ☐ Reluctant ☐ Refused (recorded above)
Session productive?	☐ Yes ☐ Partially ☐ Child was not in a space for it today
Follow-up with PIC needed?	☐ No ☐ Yes — reason:
Inform social worker of anything?	☐ No ☐ Yes — detail:
Care plan / placement plan update needed?	☐ No ☐ Yes

Keyworker Signature: _____ Date: _____

Next Session Scheduled: _____

PIC Reviewed: _____ Date: _____

9 KEYWORKING SESSION INDEX (PER CHILD)

Running log of all sessions for this child. Filed at the front of the keyworking section in the child's file.

#	Date	Keyworker	Duration	Key Topics	Safeguarding?	Actions?	Signed?
1					☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N	☐
2					☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N	☐
3					☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N	☐
4					☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N	☐
5					☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N	☐
6					☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N	☐
7					☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N	☐
8					☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N	☐
9					☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N	☐
10					☐ Y ☐ N	☐ Y ☐ N	☐

Frequency: Minimum fortnightly (HIQA expectation). More frequent where child's needs or risk level require it.

Legislative Basis: HIQA National Standards 2018 (Standards 1, 2, 3) · UNCRC Articles 12 & 13 (child's right to be heard) · S.I. 259/1995 · Children First Act 2015

Ref: CM-KWS-001 | Version 1.0 | May 2025 | Filed in: Child's Individual File — Keyworking Section